ABSOLUTE / UPAJ

SilkRoute: a commodity marketplace from discovery to trade

Connecting catalogue, negotiation, payments and operations in a cross-border B2B trading product.

Role: Product leadership across the Absolute portfolio | Period: October 2021–November 2024

Reported outcomes and scope

$100M · Reported transaction value

Reached within nine months in the supplied career records.

Mobile + web · Documented product surfaces

The product problem

Commodity trading relied on broker networks, messaging groups and offline contracts. Absolute had a producer-side footprint, but converting that network into transactions required more than publishing a catalogue. Buyers and sellers needed a path through negotiation, payment and trade execution.

My role

I worked on the mobile and web trading product from its early build, including trader research, process digitisation, requirements and delivery coordination. The March 2022 CV documents investigating payment failures and turning operational issues into product priorities.

What I built

The marketplace work covers catalogue management, discovery, negotiation and matching. Research with farmers, FPOs and traders helped connect the digital journey to the existing way the business traded.

Payment and ERP workflows formed part of the transaction lifecycle. Regional rollout required coordination across product, engineering, finance, operations and country teams, with customs and trade documentation incorporated into delivery.

Working from the way traders already operated

I researched farmers, FPOs and rural and small-town traders, including the existing processes and payment failures around live business. The aim was to bring regular trading into a mobile and web marketplace without leaving the difficult operating steps outside the product. Catalogue and discovery had to connect with negotiation, matching and settlement.

I led product development for those connected modules. Direct buyer-seller negotiation was included because this was a large-ticket B2B journey rather than a retail catalogue with a fixed checkout. The work digitised the process around the transaction as well as the customer-facing screens; the payment gateway and internal ERP formed part of that delivery.

Coordinating delivery with a live trading business

I managed Jira, task prioritisation and daily scrum calls, acting as scrum master for the technical team. Operations, finance and business colleagues supplied issues that crossed the platform boundary, and payment-failure root-cause work helped connect those issues with the backlog. This was cross-functional product coordination rather than line management of every involved team.

I supported regional rollout across India, Southeast Asia and the Middle East. The Professional Profile describes structured execution workshops with regional leadership to connect local business requirements with the common platform. The wider programme reached the reported $100 million transaction value in nine months; that scale belongs to the connected trading system, not a single catalogue or workshop intervention.

What changed

The programme reports $100 million in transaction value within nine months, supported by the mobile and web platform, payments and trade operations. Supplier, buyer and average-order counts vary across versions of the career record, so they are not combined into one headline cohort.

The lesson from this work

The product pattern is a marketplace with an operating spine: discovery and negotiation need to end in a completed trade. This case also demonstrates building around established user behaviour and investigating transaction failures rather than assuming the interface is the whole problem.

Visual references and walkthroughs

Documented workflow: Catalogue and discovery → Negotiation and price matching → Trade and compliance checks → Payment and operations → Shipment and transaction completion

An authored explanation of the workflow described in this case study. This is a diagram, not a captured product screen.

View the online case study for the full image gallery and playable videos.

Evidence and attribution

Buyer, supplier and average-order counts vary across supplied documents and are not used as consolidated headline results.

Transaction value is GMV, not platform revenue. Supplier/buyer counts and AOV vary across CV versions. Regional workshops and scrum responsibilities are documented; individual workshop decisions and velocity improvements are not.